

Introduction to Search Algorithm and Graph Algorithm

Week 3

Search : ① The process of navigating a problem space to find a solution.

② AI agents use search algorithms to decide which actions to take in an environment.

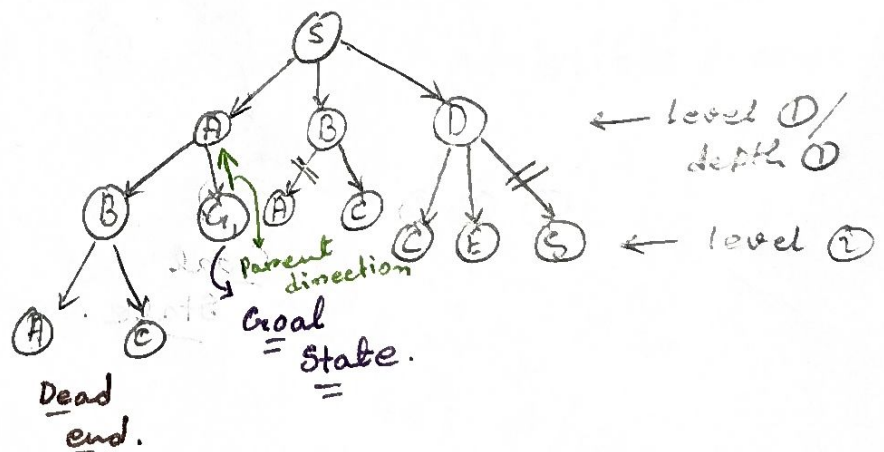
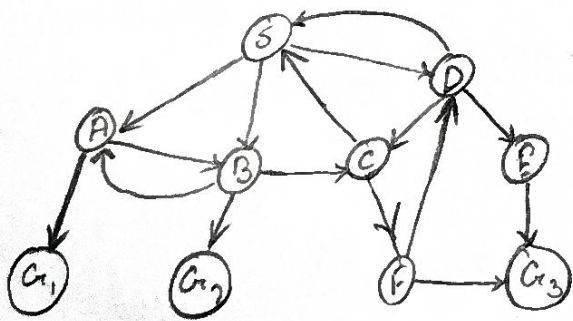
→ Types of search :

① Uninformed (Blind) Search

② Informed (Heuristic) Search.

Breadth-First Search :

- Explores all nodes at one depth before moving deeper.
- Uses a queue (FIFO) to manage nodes.
- Generates the shortest path (if all actions have the same cost).



BFS stops when reach goal state.

Visited : S, A, B, D

path : S → A → G₁

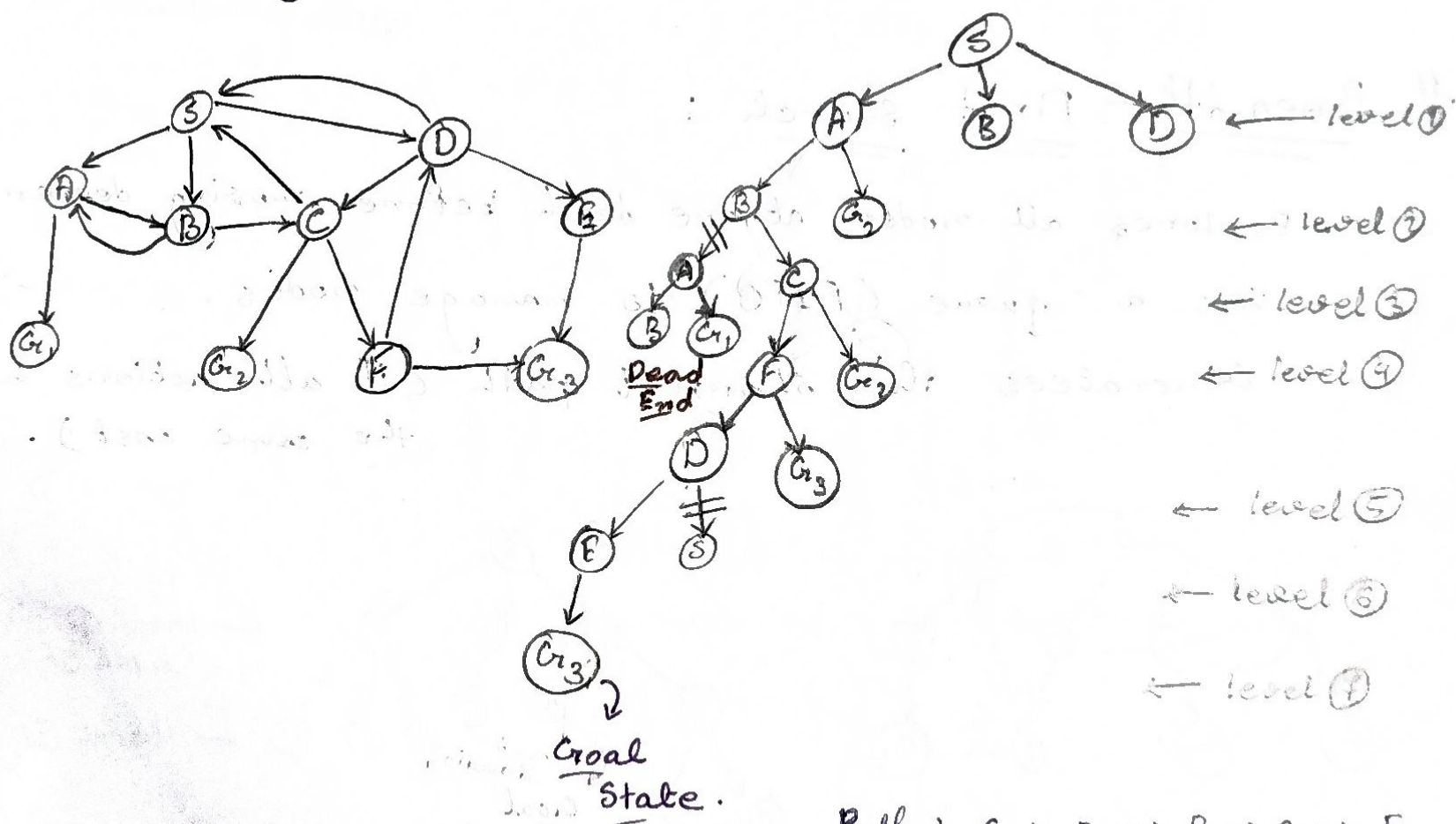
Shortest path.

Depth-First Search : uninformed se.

- ① Explore as deep as possible along a branch before backtracking.
- ② Use a stack (LIFO) for node management (can be recursive).
- ③ Memory-efficiency but may not find the shortest path.

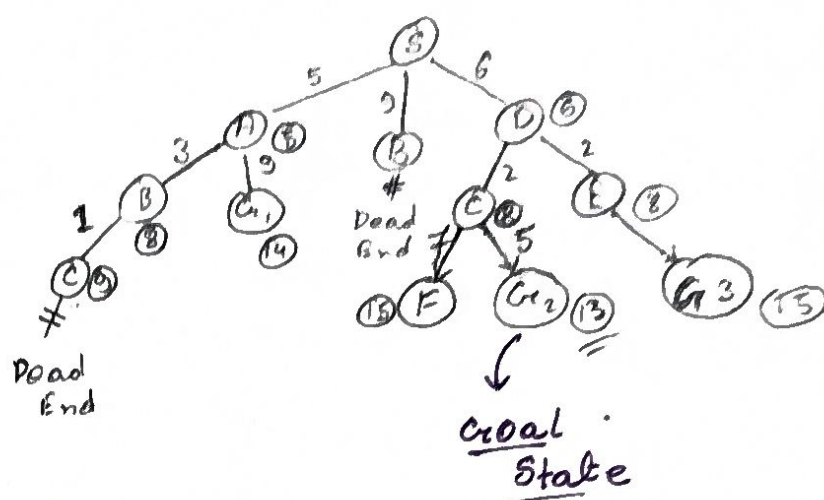
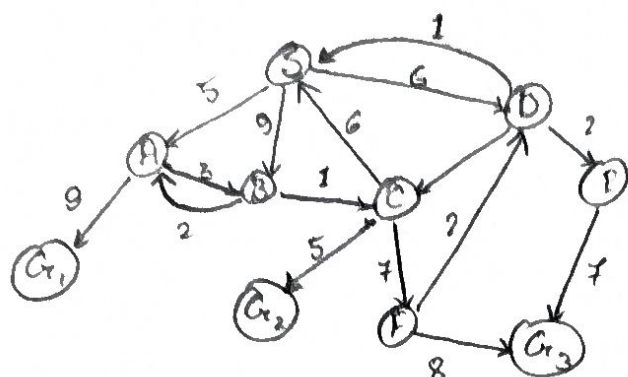
Time complexity : $O(b^d)$

Space complexity : $O(bd)$



Path : $S \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow F$
 $G_3 \leftarrow E \leftarrow D$

Search Space and Weighted Graph:



Path: $S \rightarrow D \rightarrow C \rightarrow G_2$

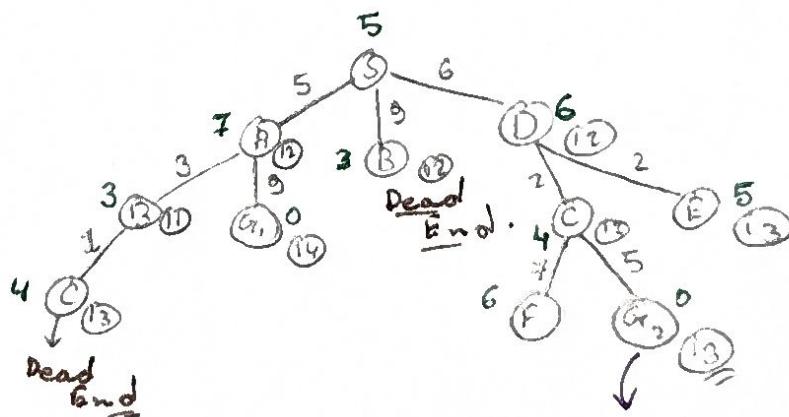
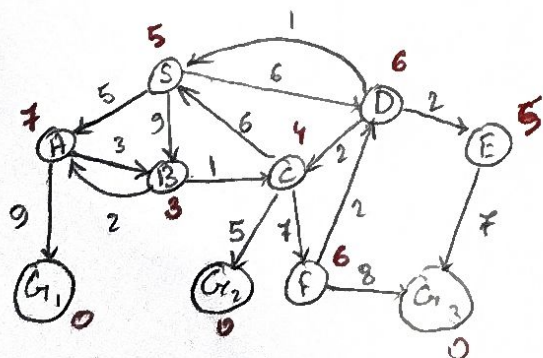
A* Search Algorithm: Informed Search

• Combines UCS with heuristics: $f(n) = g(n) + h(n)$.

• $g(n)$: Cost to reach node.

$h(n)$: estimated cost to goal (heuristic)

• Finds optimal path if heuristic is admissible (never overestimates).



Path: $S \rightarrow D \rightarrow C \rightarrow G_2$